Seung Deok Seo

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — United States
PhD in Political Science — 2022 – Present
Major: Comparative Politics, Minor: International Relations

London School of Economics and Political Science — United Kingdom
MSc in Development Studies — 2018

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies — Republic of Korea
BA in Arabic Interpretation and Translation — 2016

Additional Education

Hebrew University of Jerusalem (Rothberg International School) — Israel
Summer Course: The History of the Arab-Israeli Conflict — 2019

University of Jordan — Jordan
Study Abroad Program (Hankuk University of Foreign Studies) — 2015

Bourguiba Institute of Modern Languages — Tunisia
Arabic Language Training — 2014

Cairo University — Egypt
Arabic Language Training (with Hankuk University of Foreign Studies) — 2011

Professional Experience

Korea International Cooperation Agency — Republic of Korea and Iraq
Development Cooperation Junior Consultant – Middle East/North Africa — 2021

UN Women Palestine Office — Palestinian Territories
Social Media and Youth Engagement Officer — 2022

Fellowships and Grants

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Illinois Global Institute Language Fellowship (Arabic), $20,000 — 2024
Kneier Fellowship $3,927 — 2023

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies
First Distinction Scholarship, $1,700 — 2016
Study Abroad Scholarship, $3,700 — 2015
Department Chief Scholarship, $1,100 — 2014

Work in progress

[3] Humanitarianism or Geopolitics? Unveiling Saudi Arabia's Humanitarian Aid Strategy in the Yemeni Civil War

[2] Beyond Economic and Political Motives: Exploring the Religious Dynamics in Gulf States' Foreign Aid Allocation (with Paul Un)

[1] Does Foreign Aid Create Disharmony among NGOs? The case of Palestine

Teaching experience

Grader, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

PS 322: Law and Public Policy (Prof. Joseph Hinchliffe)	Spring 2024
PS 250: Rise Up: Organizing Resistance (Prof. Rana Khoury)	Fall 2023
PS 220: Intro to Public Policy (Prof. Jeffrey Ashley)	Fall 2022

Conferences

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) 2020

Does Foreign Aid Create Disharmony among NGOs? The case of Palestine

Skills

Languages

Korean: Native
English: Professional fluency
Arabic (Modern Standard Arabic; Levantine dialect):
Advanced (reading); Intermediate (speaking, writing)

Programming

R, LaTeX, SPSS, Qualtrics, Markdown

Other interests

Photography, Basketball, and Lego